

Cold-Call Audition Preparation

INTERVIEW PREP | SKILL: INTERVIEW | DIFFICULTY: INTERMEDIATE | EST. 15 MIN

Reviewed professional resource - AmplifyHub Practical Resource Library

Overview

Preparation for the live mock cold call many SDR interviews include: what they are assessing, how to prepare an adaptable opener, and how to stay composed when the "prospect" pushes back.

Learning objectives

- Understand what a mock-call assessor looks for
- Prepare an adaptable opener and one question
- Stay calm through an objection
- Debrief your own performance honestly

What they usually assess

- Can you open clearly and get to the point?
- Do you ask a question and listen, or just pitch?
- How do you react to a "not interested"?
- Are you coachable when they give feedback?

Prepare in four steps

1. Write a short, adaptable opener you can say naturally.
2. Prepare one open question and one calm objection response.
3. Run the mock with the AI Coach audition track twice.
4. Debrief: one thing you did well, one thing to adjust.

Professional standard

Professional interview preparation connects honest evidence to the employer's real requirements. Answers should be structured enough to follow, flexible enough for dialogue, and precise about what you personally did and learned.

Professional workflow

1. Study the job description and company before completing the resource. Match your preparation to the actual role rather than a generic sales interview.
2. Build answers from real evidence: work, study, volunteering, projects, or deliberate practice. Label estimates honestly and never invent experience.
3. Practise aloud with a timer, then repeat with a follow-up question or interruption. Strong answers stay clear when the conversation changes.
4. Ask a reviewer or the AI Coach to score clarity, evidence, relevance, and concision. Convert broad feedback into one specific revision.
5. Prepare a concise version and a fuller version of each answer. Use the concise version first and add detail only when the interviewer asks.

Quality-control review

Review point

Relevance

Professional standard

The answer addresses the role requirement and the exact

Warning sign

A polished story is used even when it does not answer the

	question asked.	question.
Evidence	Actions, decisions, and results are specific and attributable.	Team outcomes are claimed as personal achievements.
Structure	The answer has a clear beginning, evidence, and conclusion.	Context expands while the important action remains vague.
Reflection	Learning and future application are stated honestly.	The answer ends with a result but shows no self-awareness.

Evidence and improvement signals

- Time both a 60-90 second version and a fuller two-minute version of key answers.
- Map every prepared example to the job requirement it supports.
- Record follow-up questions you struggled with and strengthen the underlying evidence.
- Review accuracy, clarity, and relevance before trying to sound more impressive.

Worked example (composure)

Assessor: "I am not interested." You: "That is fair - can I ask one quick thing and then let you go? Is it the timing, or just not a fit right now?" Staying curious and calm under a brush-off usually scores higher than a perfect script.

Safe-practice note

Show your real ability rather than a memorised performance; assessors can tell. If you are nervous, it is fine to say so briefly and continue. Do not fabricate experience during the mock - being coachable matters more than sounding polished.

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